

Wednesday, 2 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 22° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Light rain 20° 15°	MANCHESTER Rain 20° 15°	GLASGOW Heavy drizzle 17° 13°
------------------------------------	-------------------------------------	-------------------------------	-------------------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A British national is among 119 people rescued in Nepal, following last week's deadly floods near the Tibet border.

Over 3,900 people are still missing after the devastating floodwaters swept across the region. Rescue efforts are continuing in challenging conditions.

DISASTER · UK
- 2

A two-day sea search for a missing 15-year-old on holiday in Pembrokeshire has tragically been called off.

The teenager, from Yorkshire, was at Marloes Sands beach when they went missing. Our thoughts are with their family.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 3

Donald Trump has indicated that the US position on the Falkland Islands is 'one of many' under review.

The UK government has firmly stated that Falkland islanders are British and have the right to determine their own future. The islands have been a point of contention for decades.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

Norway has a new King, as he took his oath of office with mourners paying respects to his late father, King Harald V.

King Harald V is currently lying in state at the Royal Palace. This marks a significant moment for the Norwegian monarchy.

ROYALTY · INTERNATIONAL
- 5

The US has launched further strikes on Iran, with state media reporting explosions in the region.

US Central Command has accused Iran of targeting commercial shipping and American service members. Tensions in the Middle East continue to escalate.

CONFLICT · INTERNATIONAL

What's coming up

1 **Fans of the late Dolly Parton will be thrilled to hear that a special festival honouring her life is planned for Nashville and London.**

DollyFest will take the place of a traditional public memorial, just as the beloved artist wished. It's a chance for fans to celebrate her incredible legacy.

ON AIR – Are you a big Dolly Parton fan? What's your favourite song or memory of her?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Sci-fi fans are aiming for a record-breaking Vulcan salute on Star Trek Day, with an event planned at the Science Museum.**

It's a fantastic way to celebrate the iconic franchise and its enduring impact. Hopefully, they'll live long and prosper in their attempt!

ON AIR – Are you a Trekkie? What's your favourite Star Trek series or character?

TV · COMING UP

3 **Long-running medical drama Casualty is set to celebrate its 40th anniversary with a special two-part episode in September.**

A familiar face from the show's past will be leading the special, promising a memorable milestone for fans. It's been a staple of Saturday night TV for decades.

ON AIR – Do you remember watching Casualty from the beginning? Who's your favourite character from over the years?

TV · COMING UP

4 **Victoria Beckham's fashion and beauty company has announced its first profit after 18 years in business.**

The brand has made a £7.3 million operating profit, marking a significant turnaround after years of losses. It seems Posh Spice's business empire is finally thriving.

ON AIR – Have you ever bought anything from Victoria Beckham's brand? Do you admire her business acumen?

FASHION · NOW

5 **An actor who was told he had Alzheimer's is now performing a one-man show of a famous Samuel Beckett play in London.**

Peter Marinker is taking on a challenging role alone on stage, showcasing incredible resilience and talent. It sounds like a truly inspiring story.

ON AIR – What's the most inspiring performance you've ever seen? Have you ever overcome a personal challenge to achieve something big?

THEATRE · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1** **Everton have agreed a deal to re-sign England international Jack Grealish on a season-long loan from Manchester City.**

This comes as Beto departs the club for Fiorentina. It's a big move for Grealish and could be a game-changer for Everton's season.

ON AIR – What do you make of Jack Grealish's return to Everton? Good move for him, or a step down?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2** **Aston Villa have completed the signings of Senegalese winger Ibrahim Mbaye and English centre-back Taylor Harwood-Bellis.**

Mbaye joins from Paris St-Germain, while Harwood-Bellis arrives from Southampton. These look like strong additions to the Villa squad.

ON AIR – Are you an Aston Villa fan? How do you rate these new signings for the season ahead?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3** **Celtic have strengthened their squad by signing Parma midfielder Oliver Sorensen on loan, with more additions expected.**

Assistant manager Shaun Maloney hinted that up to four new players could arrive before the Europa League squad deadline. It's a busy time for the Scottish champions.

ON AIR – Are you a Celtic supporter? What other players would you like to see them sign before the deadline?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4** **Britain's Arthur Fery is making a return to the Grand Slam stage, facing Italy's Lorenzo Musetti at the US Open.**

Fery was a shock semi-finalist at Wimbledon, and all eyes will be on him to see if he can repeat that success. It's a huge opportunity for him.

ON AIR – Are you following the US Open? Who are you tipping for glory this year?

TENNIS · UK
- 5** **Novak Djokovic was overcome with emotion during his first-round loss at the US Open against Argentina's Mariano Navone.**

The tennis legend broke down in tears after the unexpected defeat. It just goes to show how much every match means to these top athletes.

ON AIR – What's the most emotional sporting moment you've ever witnessed? Does it make you feel more connected to the athletes?

TENNIS · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that wearing socks to bed might actually help you drift off faster.**
Researchers found that warming your feet can dilate blood vessels, signalling to your brain that it's time to relax and prepare for sleep. So, if you're struggling to nod off, perhaps a cosy pair of socks is the answer!
- 2 The humble act of 'pottering' in the garden is being hailed as a fantastic stress-reliever and mood booster.**
Simply spending time tending to plants, even without a grand plan, provides a gentle physical activity and a connection to nature that many find incredibly calming. It's a wonderful way to unwind.
- 3 Families are increasingly turning to 'board game nights' as a way to reconnect and switch off from screens.**
Sales of classic and new board games have seen a steady rise, with people enjoying the face-to-face interaction and friendly competition. It's a lovely way to spend quality time together without digital distractions.
- 4 The enduring appeal of 'vintage vinyl records' continues to spin, with record shops reporting a surge in interest.**
Many music lovers are rediscovering the joy of physical albums, from the ritual of putting a record on to the rich sound quality. It's a nostalgic journey for some, and a new experience for others.
- 5 A surprising benefit of 'daydreaming' has been identified: it can actually boost your problem-solving skills.**
Allowing your mind to wander gives your brain a chance to make new connections and process information subconsciously, often leading to creative solutions. So, don't feel guilty about letting your thoughts drift!
- 6 More people are finding joy in the simple art of 'letter writing', not just for special occasions, but for everyday chats.**
The thoughtful process of putting pen to paper and the anticipation of receiving a handwritten note creates a unique and personal connection that emails often can't replicate. It's a charming way to communicate.
- 7 The satisfying crunch of 'crispy autumn leaves' underfoot is surprisingly uplifting for many.**
A recent informal poll found that the sound and sensation of walking through fallen leaves brings a distinct sense of seasonal cheer and nostalgia. It's one of those small, everyday pleasures.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING THE PACKET A LITTLE SHAKE TO HEAR IF THEY RATTLE SATISFYINGLY!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a good cup of tea, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING THE TEA BAG (OR LOOSE LEAVES) DEEPLY BEFORE PUTTING IT IN THE MUG.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday object' in your home just seems to have its own little personality or a funny story attached to it?**

What's an everyday item in your house that you feel has a bit of a character or a memory associated with it? Perhaps it's a wonky lamp, a quirky mug, or a slightly battered armchair?

- **We all have those 'little acts of kindness' that we've either received or given, that really stuck with us, even if they seemed small at the time, don't we?**

What's a small, unexpected act of kindness, either given or received, that has always stayed in your memory and made a real difference to your day?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'? It's thought to be because of their wise and serious appearance.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The average cloud weighs about the same as 100 elephants, which is why they move so slowly across the sky.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest officially recorded hailstones fell in Vivian, South Dakota, in 2010, measuring 8 inches in diameter.
- The 'king' in a deck of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- Wombat poo is cube-shaped, which helps it from rolling away when they mark their territory.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.

On this day

Day 245 of the year, 120 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Acepsimas of Hnaita and companions (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Agricola of Avignon; Christian feast day: Antoninus of Pamiers; Christian feast day: Brocard. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1997 — 645AR, American rapper
- 1967 — Frank Fontserè, American drummer and songwriter
- 1992 — Ella Toone, English footballer
- 1966 — Dino Cazares, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1982 — Mark Phillips, English footballer
- 1977 — Sam Rivers, American musician (died 2025)
- 1969 — K-Ci, American R&B singer-songwriter
- 1981 — Chris Tremlett, English cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2008 — Google launches its Google Chrome web browser.
- 1968 — Operation OAU begins during the Nigerian Civil War.
- 1985 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Tamil politicians and former MPs M. Alalasundaram and V. Dharmalingam are shot dead.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1984 — Seven people are shot and killed and 12 wounded in the Milperra massacre, a shootout between the rival motorcycle gangs Bandidos and Comancheros in Sydney, Australia.
- 2022 — Eighteen people are killed and 23 others are injured by a suicide bombing at a Sunni mosque in Herat, Afghanistan.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2024 — At least 129 inmates are killed and 59 more injured in an attempted prison break at Makala Prison in Kinshasa, Democratic Republic of the Congo.
- 1970 — NASA announces the cancellation of two Apollo missions to the Moon, Apollo 15 (the designation is re-used by a later mission), and Apollo 19.

- 1970 — Aeroflot Flight 3630, a Tupolev Tu-124 en route from southern Russia to Lithuania, crashes after the pilots lost control of the aircraft at cruise altitude between Rostov-on-Don Airport and Vilnius Airport, on the second leg of the flight; all 37 passengers and crew are killed.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 246 of the year, 119 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Bartholomew Gutierrez; Christian feast day: Blessed Brigida Morello Zancano; Christian feast day: Mansuetus of Toul; Christian feast day: Marinus. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1992 — August Alsina, American singer-songwriter
- 1956 — Stephen Woolley, English director and producer
- 1978 — John Curtis, English footballer
- 1982 — Andrew McMahon, American singer-songwriter, pianist, and producer
- 1938 — Sarah Bradford, English historian and author
- 1925 — Anne Jackson, American actress (died 2016)
- 1948 — Don Brewer, American drummer and singer-songwriter
- 2000 — Brandon Williams, English footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — Varig Flight 254 crashes in the Amazon rainforest near São José do Xingu in Brazil, killing 12.
- 1976 — Viking program: The American Viking 2 spacecraft lands at Utopia Planitia on Mars.
- 1945 — A three-day celebration begins in China, following the Victory over Japan Day on September 2.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1944 — Holocaust: Diarist Anne Frank and her family are placed on the last transport train from the Westerbork transit camp to the Auschwitz concentration camp, arriving three days later.
- 1989 — Cubana de Aviación Flight 9046 crashes into a residential area of Havana shortly after takeoff from José Martí International Airport, killing 150.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
-------	-----------------------

FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
--------	----------------------

FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
--------	-------------------

FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
--------	---------------------

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
--------	---

FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
--------	-------------------------

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar